

Alberta Disability Assistance Program

Provides financial, health and employment supports to Albertans with severe disabilities who are able to work.

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Purpose

The Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) will empower Albertans with disabilities to pursue fulfilling job opportunities while continuing to receive the financial, health, personal and employment supports they need.

Albertans with disabilities and the organizations that support them have made it clear that they want more support and opportunities to earn a living beyond what is offered by the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program. They stressed the importance of providing pathways to employment for individuals who are able to work but still require support – something AISH is not designed to provide. ADAP was thoughtfully designed based on input from Albertans with disabilities.

How it works

Starting July 2026, the new Alberta Disability Assistance Program will become operational and there will be a single combined application for both ADAP and AISH. Eligible applicants will be placed in the program best suited to their unique situation.

ADAP will help Albertans with disabilities pursue meaningful employment while continuing to receive the financial, health and personal supports they need. ADAP's core benefit rate is among the highest in the country, providing \$300 more per month than most disability programs in Canada.

ADAP will also allow for the highest level of employment income in the country while receiving financial benefits, meaning Albertans on ADAP can earn more from working while continuing to receive the support they need. These financial benefits are in addition to health and personal benefits, which Albertans on ADAP will receive regardless of their employment income.

For more information, read the [ADAP fact sheet](#).

Public engagement

ADAP has been thoughtfully designed, based on input from Albertans with disabilities, to address a gap in supports for individuals with disabilities who are able to work and want to enjoy the benefits that come with employment, such as earning a paycheque, building relationships, developing skills, and providing a sense of purpose, belonging and independence.

ADAP public engagement concluded March 2026. Thousands of Albertans participated in engagement via roundtables, telephone town halls, written submissions and an online survey. In addition, public engagement was undertaken with disability advocates and service providers, including through roundtables and meetings.

From this, regulations were developed to set out the rules needed to deliver programs consistently, effectively and in line with legislation.

We thank all participants for sharing their feedback throughout the engagement process that helped shape the Alberta Disability Assistance Program.

Progress

- February 2025

ADAP was announced.

- Fall 2025

Enabling legislation was passed.

- March 2026

Decisions made from results of public engagement.

- Spring 2026

Regulations are finalized and will come into force July 2026, concurrent with related legislative amendments.

We are here

- July 2026

ADAP launches.

Previous date

Next date

Benefits and income exemptions

When ADAP launches July 2026, ADAP clients will receive a monthly benefit of up to \$1,740.

Individuals

When ADAP launches July 2026, ADAP's core financial benefit will be \$1,740 per month.

The ADAP employment income exemption for single clients will be \$700 per month, which means that individuals on ADAP will be able to earn up to \$700 per month with no impact to financial benefits.

- Employment income above \$700 per month will be gradually deducted starting with less than a cent per dollar and increasing significantly approaching \$45,000 employment income per year.
- An [online AISH and ADAP benefits estimator](#) is available to help calculate potential benefit.
- Albertans on ADAP will be able to earn up to \$45,240 annually in employment income while continuing to receive financial benefits. This will be the highest limit for employment income while receiving financial benefits of any comparable disability income assistance program in Canada.
- Albertans on ADAP will continue to receive the health benefits they need, regardless of employment income.

Client type	Amount clients can earn before impact to financial benefits
AISH Single or Parent	\$350
ADAP Single	\$700
ADAP Parent (one or more dependent children)	\$1,100
AISH or ADAP Cohabiting Partner	\$1,500

Partners

Starting in the August 2026 benefit period, households where 2 adults receive disability income assistance (AISH or ADAP), each partner will receive 88% of the maximum individual benefit to reflect a couple's shared household expenses and mutual financial responsibility. This approach aligns with how other jurisdictions structure disability benefits and helps ensure supports are distributed fairly.

Child benefit rates

Child benefit rates under AISH and ADAP have been recalibrated to reflect other child-related supports including the federal Canada Child Benefit. Monthly child benefits are set at:

- \$300 for the first child
- \$117 for the second
- \$88 for the third
- \$59 for the fourth, and
- \$30 for each additional child

The recalibrated child benefit rates will increase child benefits for approximately 7,000 families who receive disability income assistance, and will be applied starting the August 2026 benefit period.

Transition approach

All existing AISH clients will be assured a place in either ADAP or AISH.

Alberta's government will notify all AISH recipients in mid-May with information specific to their situation, including whether they will remain on AISH, transition to ADAP, or be affected by any regulatory changes.

Current AISH clients

In July 2026, current AISH clients will transition to ADAP, except those clients who meet one or more of the below criteria. Current AISH clients who meet one or more of the below criteria will automatically remain on AISH, unless they choose to transition to ADAP to benefit from ADAP's higher employment income exemptions:

- individuals with a severe and profound developmental disability, or who are deemed eligible for or are receiving Persons with Developmental Disabilities services
- individuals with palliative or terminal medical conditions
- individuals living in continuing care homes
- individuals 60 years of age or older.

Current AISH clients who meet the criteria for automatic approval for AISH do not need to take any action – they will be identified by AISH and notified prior to July 2026.

AISH clients transitioning to ADAP

AISH clients who transition to ADAP in July 2026 will receive a \$200 monthly transition benefit that will keep their financial benefit the same as their existing AISH benefit amount until December 31, 2027. During this time, clients can choose to remain on ADAP or apply for AISH.

Alberta's government will cover the cost of one medical assessment for current AISH clients who transition to ADAP in July and later choose to be reassessed for AISH. This support is not time-limited and will be available whenever clients choose to access it.

Combined application for AISH and ADAP

There will be one application for both AISH and ADAP. This application will collect information from the applicant and their medical professional(s) to decide if an applicant meets the general, financial, and medical requirements. If eligible for the general and financial requirements, an adjudicator will review the medical information to decide if an applicant qualifies for ADAP or should be referred to a panel of medical professionals to determine eligibility for AISH. Eligible applicants will be placed into the program that best suits their unique needs and abilities.

In general, an individual with a severe disability that results in them being permanently unable to work will qualify for AISH.

In general, an individual with a severe disability who is assessed as able to work will qualify for ADAP. To be medically eligible for ADAP, the severe disability must be determined to significantly restrict but not prevent a person from being employed.

ADAP clients will be able to apply for an AISH assessment if their medical condition or ability to work changes.

All existing AISH clients will be assured a place in either ADAP or AISH. AISH clients who transition to ADAP in July 2026 will receive a \$200 monthly transition benefit that will keep their financial benefit the same as their existing AISH benefit amount until December 31, 2027. During this time, clients can choose to remain on ADAP or apply for AISH.

If an individual disagrees with a decision about their disability income assistance application, there are ways to appeal. For an ADAP decision, they can appeal through the ADAP Medical Appeal Panel or the Citizen's Appeal Panel, depending on the type of decision.

Decisions by the disability assistance adjudicator to not refer an application to the AISH Medical Review Panel for an AISH eligibility determination can be appealed to the new ADAP Medical Appeal Panel. Decisions by the

disability assistance adjudicator to determine an applicant is not eligible for ADAP can also be appealed. The Citizen's Appeal Panel will continue to hear non-medical eligibility appeals.

Employment supports

Through ADAP, Albertans with disabilities will receive customized, one-on-one support and access to the resources and tools they need to gain new skills and work to their full potential. Employment supports include holistic wraparound supports designed to address a wide range of personal, social and practical barriers that may impact an individual's ability to gain and retain employment.

Through Budget 2026, Alberta's government is investing an unprecedented nearly quarter-billion dollars this year alone to help Albertans gain and retain meaningful employment. This investment strengthens supports that reduce barriers for persons with disabilities and provide flexible, person-centred supports focused on long-term success. These services include career planning, assistive technology and supported job placements, as well as resources to help employers break down accessibility barriers in their workplace.

If an ADAP client is unable to find a job after receiving employment supports, they will continue to receive their financial and health benefits. If their medical condition progresses to the point that they are unable to work, they can apply for the AISH program.